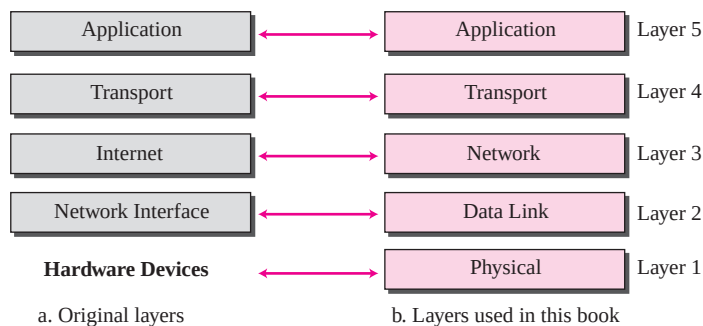
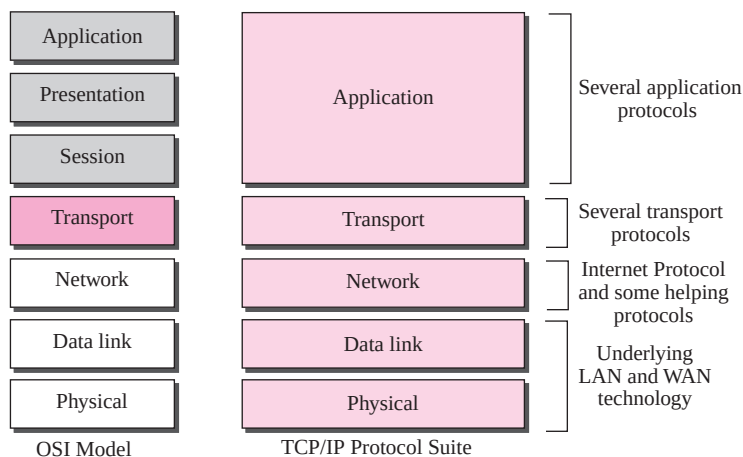


Figure 2.7 Layers in the TCP/IP Protocol Suite**Figure 2.8** TCP/IP and OSI model

Two reasons were mentioned for this decision. First, TCP/IP has more than one transport-layer protocol. Some of the functionalities of the session layer are available in some of the transport layer protocols. Second, the application layer is not only one piece of software. Many applications can be developed at this layer. If some of the functionalities mentioned in the session and presentation are needed for a particular application, it can be included in the development of that piece of software.

TCP/IP is a hierarchical protocol made up of interactive modules, each of which provides a specific functionality, but the modules are not necessarily interdependent. Whereas the OSI model specifies which functions belong to each of its layers, the layers of the TCP/IP protocol suite contain relatively independent protocols that can be mixed and matched, depending on the needs of the system. The term *hierarchical* means that each upper level protocol is supported by one or more lower level protocols.